

Research Guide: Twin Cities Contractor Database Development

Ethical Research Methods for Contractor Contact Information

1. Public Databases and Directories

Minnesota Department of Labor and Industry (DLI)

- Contractor license database: <https://mn.gov/dli/licensing/>
- Search for licensed contractors in Twin Cities area
- Filter by license type and business size
- Export available data (company name, address, license status)
- Contact information often available through follow-up research

Minnesota Secretary of State Business Directory

- Business registration information
- Officer/owner names and addresses
- Company formation details
- Contact information when available

City Business License Databases

- Minneapolis: <https://lims.minneapolismn.gov/>
- St. Paul: <https://www.stpaul.gov/>
- Search for construction business licenses
- Often includes company contact information

City of Minneapolis Subcontractor Registry

- Small and underutilized businesses database
- Includes Disadvantaged Business Enterprise (DBE)-certified companies
- Covers construction and other services
- Geographic scope: Anoka, Carver, Chisago, Dakota, Hennepin, Isanti, Le Sueur, Mille Lacs, Ramsey, Scott, Sherburne, Sibley, Washington, and Wright counties in Minnesota; Pierce and St. Croix counties in Wisconsin
- Contact: Johnnie Burns, Associate Director, Contract Compliance Division
- Address: City Hall, 350 Fifth St. S., Room 239, Minneapolis, MN 55415
- Office hours: 8:30 a.m. – 4:30 p.m., Monday – Friday
- Search for DBE-certified construction contractors in the Twin Cities area

2. Industry Association Directories

Associated General Contractors (AGC) of Minnesota

- Member directory with company profiles

- Company size and specialty information
- Contact persons and company details
- Membership indicates serious industry commitment

Minnesota Construction Association (MCA)

- Contractor member directory
- Government contracting focus (relevant for your expansion)
- Company profiles with specialties

Home Builders Association of Minnesota

- Residential contractor listings
- Builder and remodeler directories
- Contact information for residential market

3. Online Business Directories

Google My Business

- Search “construction contractors Minneapolis”
- Filter by ratings and company size indicators
- Often includes contact information directly
- Customer reviews provide market intelligence

Yellow Pages and Superpages

- Construction category searches
- Filter by Twin Cities metro area
- Often includes phone numbers and addresses

Angie’s List / Handy

- Contractor profiles with business information
- Customer rating information
- Service area confirmation

4. Government Project Research

Minnesota Department of Transportation (MnDOT)

- Current projects database
- Contractor information for active projects
- Bid results showing successful contractors
- Subcontractor information often available

GovernmentBid.com and FedRooms

- Government project announcements
- Contractor prequalification lists
- Bid results showing winning contractors
- Upcoming opportunities to target

5. Trade Publication Directories

Midwest Construction Magazine

- Contractor ranking lists
- Project feature articles with contractor names
- Awards and recognition lists
- Market intelligence for larger contractors

Minneapolis/St. Paul Business Journal

- Contractor market rankings
- Top contractor lists by revenue
- Project announcements with contractor names

6. Research Framework for 200+ Contractors

Target Profile Definition:

- Company size: \$2M-\$50M annual revenue (estimated)
- Employee count: 10-50 employees
- Geographic focus: Twin Cities metro area
- Services: General construction, specialty trades
- Years in business: 3+ years (established)

Classification System:

- **Tier 1:** Large contractors (\$20M+ revenue) - 50 companies
- **Tier 2:** Mid-size contractors (\$5M-\$20M) - 100 companies
- **Tier 3:** Small established contractors (\$2M-\$5M) - 75 companies
- **Tier 4:** Emerging contractors (\$1M-\$2M) - 50 companies

Data Points to Collect:

- Company name
- Primary contact name and title
- Phone number
- Email address (often info@[company], contact@[company])
- Website
- Annual revenue (estimated)
- Employee count (estimated)
- Primary services

- Geographic service area
- Years in business
- License numbers
- Insurance carrier (if publicly available)

7. Contact Verification Process

Primary Research Methods:

- Visit company website directly
- Call company main line and ask for estimating contact
- Check LinkedIn for key personnel
- Search for company in news articles
- Verify business address and status

Quality Assurance:

- Verify business is active and in good standing
- Confirm company provides services you can support
- Ensure geographic area aligns with your service area
- Validate contact person is appropriate for estimating services

8. Outreach Strategy Once Compiled

Initial Contact Methods:

- Direct phone call to introduce services
- Professional email introduction
- LinkedIn connection requests
- Direct mail (for local companies)

Value Proposition Alignment:

- For mid-size contractors: “Free up your estimator’s time for bigger projects”
- For smaller contractors: “Access to commercial estimating expertise without hiring costs”
- For government contractors: “Prevailing wage and compliance expertise”

9. Tools to Assist Research

Spreadsheet Software:

- Track all collected information
- Sort and filter by criteria
- Track contact attempts and responses
- Schedule follow-up activities

CRM Options:

- HubSpot Free (good for list management)
- Pipedrive (simple contact management)
- Insightly (contact and project tracking)

Contact Verification Tools:

- Hunter.io (find and verify email addresses)
- Voila Norbert (find contact information)
- Clearbit Connect (enrich contact information)

10. Legal and Ethical Guidelines**CAN-SPAM Compliance:**

- Only contact businesses with legitimate interest
- Provide clear opt-out mechanisms
- Use accurate sender information
- Honor opt-out requests immediately

Privacy Considerations:

- Only use publicly available information
- Don't purchase lists from unknown sources
- Respect company preferences regarding contact
- Follow industry association guidelines

Professional Ethics:

- Don't misrepresent services or company
- Be transparent about business purpose
- Respect Do Not Call registries
- Follow up professionally without harassment

11. Research Schedule Recommendation**Week 1-2: Database Mining**

- Focus on public databases (DLI, Secretary of State)
- Industry association directories
- Government project databases

Week 3-4: Online Research

- Business directories and Google My Business
- Trade publication research
- LinkedIn research for contact persons

Week 5-6: Verification and Validation

- Call companies to verify information
- Confirm appropriate contact persons
- Begin initial outreach to top prospects

This systematic approach will help you build a quality database of Twin Cities contractors through legitimate means, providing a strong foundation for your business development efforts.